METHODOLOGY DOCUMENT
MSCI SUSTAINABILITY AND CLIMATE

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MSCI ESG Ratings Methodology: Financing Environmental Impact Key Issue

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Contents

Introduction **3**
Risks associated with this Key Issue **4**
Financing Environmental Impact Key Issue score **4**
Financing Environmental Impact Management framework **4**
Financing Environmental Impact Management score **5**
Financing Environmental Impact Systems score 6
Financing Environmental Impact Integration score 7
Financing Environmental Impact Oversight score 7
Financing Environmental Impact Policy score 7
Financing Environmental Impact Opportunities score 8
Treatment of covered bonds issuers 9
Controversies 9
Financing Environmental Impact Exposure score **9**
Business Exposure score 10
Business Segment Exposure scores 11
Company-Specific Exposure score 11
Data sources 12
Contact us **13**

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Introduction

This document provides essential information on the components of the Financing Environmental Impact Key Issue to enable users of ESG Ratings to understand how MSCI Sustainability & Climate's (MSCI S&C's)[1] outputs are determined. Financing Environmental Impact is a Key Issue in the Environmental Pillar of the MSCI ESG Ratings model. Financial institutions are evaluated on the environmental risks of their lending and underwriting activities and their ability to capitalize on opportunities related to green finance.

For additional details on the MSCI ESG Ratings Model, refer to the Data, ratings and scores section of "ESG Ratings Methodology."

Exhibit 1: MSCI ESG Key Issue Hierarchy

3 Pillars	10 Themes	33 ESG Key Issues
Environmental	**Climate Change**	Carbon Emissions
		Climate Change Vulnerability
		Financing Environmental Impact
		Product Carbon Footprint
	Natural Capital	Biodiversity & Land Use
		Raw Material Sourcing
		Water Stress
	Pollution & Waste	Electronic Waste
		Packaging Material & Waste
		Toxic Emissions & Waste
	Environmental Opportunities	Opportunities in Clean Tech
		Opportunities in Green Building
		Opportunities in Renewable Energy
Social	Human Capital	Health & Safety
		Human Capital Development
		Labor Management
		Supply Chain Labor Standards
	Product Liability	Chemical Safety
		Consumer Financial Protection
		Privacy & Data Security
		Product Safety & Quality
		Responsible Investment
	Stakeholder Opposition	Community Relations
		Controversial Sourcing
	Social Opportunities	Access to Finance
		Access to Health Care
		Opportunities in Nutrition & Health
Governance	Corporate Governance	Board

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3 Pillars	10 Themes	33 ESG Key Issues
		Pay
		Ownership & Control
		Accounting
	Corporate Behavior	Business Ethics
		Tax Transparency

Risks associated with this Key Issue

- Increased credit defaults from borrowers that suffer losses related to a range of environmental concerns, including operational disruption, loss of market access, liabilities and asset impairment.
- Damage to corporate reputation from financing environmentally harmful projects.

Financing Environmental Impact Key Issue score

The Financing Environmental Impact Key Issue score evaluates the company's level of exposure to, and management of risks on this Key Issue. The Key Issue score on this Key Issue is based on the Exposure score and the Management score using the formula below. The Exposure score and the Management score are combined such that a higher level of exposure requires a higher level of demonstrated management capability in order to achieve the same overall Key Issue score.

$$KI_i = 7 - (\max(EXP_i, 2) - MGMT_i)$$

Where:

- KI_i is the Key Issue score for company i.
- EXP_i is the Exposure score for company i.
- $MGMT_i$is the Management score for company i.

Financing Environmental Impact Management framework

The table below outlines the indicators mapped to their respective components that inform the Financing Environmental Impact Management score, excluding controversies. MSCI S&C assigns each indicator a default weight. Indicator weights may be adjusted at the company level to reflect the relevance of the indicator to the company's business activities. If a company has no exposure to the business activities covered by an indicator, the indicator is assigned a weight of zero.

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Component	Sustainability Indicator
Financing Environmental Impact Systems score	Formal management systems to assess ESG risks in financing activities
	Scope of management system to assess ESG risks in financing activities
Financing Environmental Impact Integration score	Involvement of group credit risk in ESG due diligence
	ESG due diligence triggers and risk escalation process clearly defined
Financing Environmental Impact Oversight score	Oversight of ESG risk management in financing activities
	Conducts climate-related risk analysis
Financing Environmental Impact Policy score	Environmental credit policy score
Financing Environmental Impact Opportunity score	Involvement in green financing and securities
	Sustainability-related financial product development

Financing Environmental Impact Management score

The Management score evaluates the company's ability to manage its exposure to risks on this Key Issue. It is based on weighted average of the score associated with each relevant indicator, modified by controversies.

This score is derived from indicators that are scored on a 0-10 scale, with 10 corresponding to best practice and 0 corresponding to lack of management. Refer to the Analyzing risk management section of "ESG Ratings Methodology" for additional details. Sources are company disclosures except where otherwise indicated.

The following formula is used to calculate the Financing Environmental Impact Management score - Excluding Controversies:

$$MGMT_i = \sum Indicator_Score_{j,i} * Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $MGMT_i$ is the Management score - Excluding Controversies for company i.
- $Indicator_Score_{j,i}$ is the score of indicator j for company i.

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- $Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$ is the weight of indicator j for company i.

The following formula is used to calculate the scores for the components

$$COMP_{c,i} = \sum_{j \in c} Indicator_Score_{j,i} * Indicator_Weight_Scaled_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $COMP_{c,i}$ is the component score for component c, for company i.
- $Indicator_Score_{j,i}$ is the score of indicator j for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_Scaled_{j,i}$ is the scaled weight of indicator j for company i.
- $j \in c$ indicates that the summation is over all indicators belonging to component c.

The following formula is used to calculate the weights for the components

$$COMP_Weight_{c,i} = \sum_{j \in c} Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $COMP_Weight_{c,i}$ is the component weight for component c for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$ is the weight of indicator j for company i.
- $j \in c$ indicates that the summation is over all indicators belonging to component c.

The definitions of the data points in each component are given below:

Financing Environmental Impact Systems score

The Financing Environmental Impact Systems score evaluates the company's initiatives to establish formal management systems for assessing ESG risks in financing activities. It is expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong initiatives.

- **Formal management systems to assess ESG risks in financing activities**

Definition: Describes the company's management system to assess ESG risks in financing activities. Best practice includes ESG factors systematically embedded in credit assessment, supported by a documented, end-to-end framework that sets out the risk management process.

- **Scope of management system to assess ESG risks in financing activities**

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Definition: The scope of a company's formal management systems to assess ESG risks in financing activities. Best practice is to include all credit and investment banking operations.

Financing Environmental Impact Integration score

The Financing Environmental Impact Integration score evaluates the company's initiatives to integrate ESG considerations into credit risk management, including the role of credit risk teams in due diligence and the presence of clear ESG risk escalation processes. It is expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong initiatives.

- **Involvement of group credit risk in ESG due diligence**

Definition: The extent to which the group responsible for credit risk management is directly involved in ESG due diligence.

- **ESG due diligence triggers and risk-escalation process clearly defined**

Definition: The level of transparency provided around the escalation process for triggering credit evaluations based on ESG risks. Best practices are to clearly define the ESG risk escalation process, provide details on thresholds for triggering escalation, and provide examples of extra due diligence where necessary.

Financing Environmental Impact Oversight score

The Financing Environmental Impact Oversight score evaluates the company's initiatives to oversee ESG risk management in financing activities, including accountability for ESG integration and climate-related risk analysis. It is expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong initiatives.

- **Oversight of ESG risk management in financing activities**

Definition: The group or individual that has ultimate responsibility over the integration of ESG considerations in financing and investment activities.

- **Conducts climate-related risk analysis**

Definition: The company's initiatives to assess the business risks associated with climate change. Best practice is to integrate climate change risk analysis in financing decisions.

Financing Environmental Impact Policy score

The Financing Environmental Impact Policy score evaluates the company's initiatives to manage environmental risks in financing activities through credit policies that cover key high-impact sectors or

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themes, such as agriculture, power utilities, mining, oil and gas and biodiversity. It is expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong initiatives.

- **Environmental credit policy score**

Definition: Assesses the scope and strength of a financial institution implementing environmental credit policy across five sectors and themes: agriculture, power utilities, mining, oil & gas, biodiversity. Expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates binding environmental credit policies applied across all five sectors and themes.

  - **Credit policy related to agriculture**

    Definition: Indicates whether the company has developed binding or non-binding environmental credit policies, or has adopted voluntary standards, related to agriculture industry financing.

  - **Credit policy related to power utilities**

    Definition: Indicates whether the company has developed binding or non-binding environmental credit policies, or has adopted voluntary standards, related to power industry financing.

  - **Credit policy related to mining**

    Definition: Indicates whether the company has developed binding or non-binding environmental credit policies, or has adopted voluntary standards, related to mining industry financing.

  - **Credit policy related to oil and gas**

    Definition: Indicates whether the company has developed binding or non-binding environmental credit policies, or has adopted voluntary standards, related to oil and gas industry financing.

  - **Credit policy related to biodiversity**

    Definition: Indicates whether the company has developed binding or non-binding environmental credit policies, or has adopted voluntary standards, related to biodiversity.

Financing Environmental Impact Opportunities score

The Financing Environmental Impact Opportunities score evaluates the company's initiatives to expand green financing opportunities through involvement in sustainable securities and the development of sustainability-linked financial products. It is expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong initiatives.

- **Involvement in green financing and securities**

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Definition: The extent to which a company invests in green securities or is involved in the structuring of green financing.

- **Sustainability-related financial product development**

Definition: The extent to which a company has integrated sustainability factors into its financial products, either through pricing mechanisms or other related green financing methods.

Treatment of covered bonds issuers

For institutions that are exclusively refinancing vehicles for multiple loan originators via the issuance of covered bonds, the Financing Environmental Impact Management score is calculated through a "market standard" approach. It is computed as the average Financing Environmental Impact Management score of loan-originating credit institutions with an MSCI ESG Rating in the same domicile country. For refinancing vehicles with a single loan originator, ESG assessments are mapped to the originator.

The definition of the data point is given below:

- **Financing environmental impact practices score for covered bonds issuers**

Definition: Indicates the strength of ESG risk management practices affecting the assets in the cover pool, proxied by the average practices of loan originators in the country of domicile. Expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong practices.

Controversies

A controversy deduction ranging from 0 to 5 points is subtracted from the overall Management score based on the severity, status, and the company's role in the controversies facing the company on this Key Issue. The following categories of controversies are used in the assessment.

- Controversial investment controversies.

For more details on how controversies are included in the MSCI ESG Ratings model, refer to the Controversies cases section of "ESG Ratings Methodology."

Financing Environmental Impact Exposure score

The Financing Environmental Impact Exposure score evaluates the company's exposure to risks on this Key Issue. It is based on the Business and Company-Specific Exposure scores. The Business Exposure score and Company-Specific Exposure score are scored on a 0-10 scale, with 10 corresponding to the highest risk and 0 corresponding to the lowest risk. Refer to Section: Analyzing Risk Exposure, of "ESG

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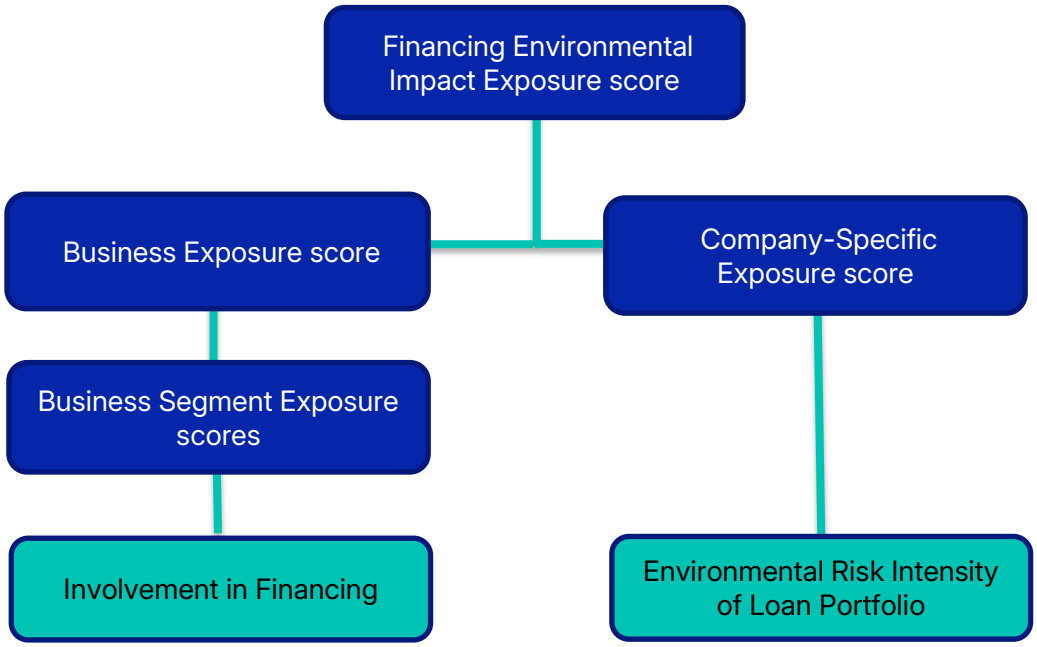
Ratings Methodology" for additional details. The following formula is used in the Financing Environmental Impact Exposure score calculation:

$$EXP_{FEI,i} = BUS_{FEI,i}(1 + 0.1(COM_{FEI,i} - 5))$$

Where:

- $EXP_{FEI,i}$ is the Financing Environmental Impact Exposure score of company i.
- $BUS_{FEI,i}$ is the Business Exposure score of company i.
- $COM_{FEI,i}$ is the Company-Specific Exposure score of company i.

Exhibit 2: Exposure score components



Business Exposure score

The Business Exposure score is a weighted average of the Business Segment Exposure scores of a company's business segments. Scores are weighted by the proportion of a company's total assets in each business segment,[2] using the following formula to calculate the Business Exposure score:

[2] The percentage of assets is typically calculated as the company-reported asset value of the segment divided by the total asset value. In certain cases, industry-specific metrics are used to calculate the percentage of assets, such as power generation, production volume or reserve value. In cases where neither segment assets nor a relevant industry-specific proxy is available, the percentage is calculated based on segment revenue.

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$$BUS_{FEI,i} = \sum_{j=1}^{n_i} w_{Asset,i,j} BSE_{FEI,j}$$

Where:

- $BSE_{FEI,j}$ is the Business Segment Exposure score for business segment j.
- $w_{Asset,i,j}$ is the weight of business segment j for company i based on the contribution to total company assets.
- n_i is the number of business segments of company i.

Business Segment Exposure scores

The Business Segment Exposure score of a business segment is based on a mapping of the business segment as disclosed by the company to a corresponding business activity. MSCI S&C uses the Standard Industrial Classification (SIC) system along with industry-specific adjustments to define business activities. The score associated with a business activity is used to calculate a Business Segment Exposure score. Each business activity score is determined by a qualitative assessment of whether a business activity has a core involvement in lending or underwriting activities. A higher involvement will result in a higher Business Segment Exposure score for the business segment.

Company-Specific Exposure score

The Company-Specific Exposure score is determined by the weighted average of environmental risk associated with the industry exposures of a loan portfolio.

$$COM_{FEI,i} = \left(Z_{ERI,i} * 2 \right) + 3$$

Where:

- $COM_{FEI,i}$ is the Company-Specific Exposure score for company i.
- $Z_{ERI,i}$ is the standardized Environmental Risk Intensity of company i's loan portfolio.

The standardized Environmental Risk Intensity of company i's loan portfolio is calculated using the following formula:

$$Z_{ERI,i} = \frac{AVG_{ERI,i} - \mu_{ACWI}}{\sigma_{ACWI}}$$

Where:

- $AVG_{ERI,i}$ is the weighted average environmental risk intensity of company i based on its loan portfolio.

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- μ_{ACWI} is the average of weighted average environmental risk intensities of companies in the MSCI ACWI Index.
- σ_{ACWI} is the standard deviation of weighted average environmental risk intensities of companies in the MSCI ACWI Index.

The weighted average environmental risk intensity of the company is the weighted average of environmental risk associated with the industry exposures of the loan portfolio, calculated using the following formula:

$$AVG_{ERI,i} = \sum_{k=1}^{n_i} lpc_{k,i} ERI_k$$

Where:

- $lpc_{k,i}$ is the value of loans to industry k as a proportion of the total loan book of company i.
- ERI_k is the environmental risk intensity score of industry k based on the industry's average risk exposure to environmental issues.
- n_i is the number of industry loan segments disclosed by company i

Data sources

The following sources are used to determine the Financing Environmental Impact Exposure score:

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